

SCRAPPED

Former Erdős Problem 249 specialist note

This is not an active mathematical paper.

Why this note was retired

The repository studies two Erdős problems, 249 and 257. Publishing a standalone technical companion for only Problem 249 gives one exploratory route a status that the overall paper programme does not justify. It also fragments the reader's route through mathematics that is already being reworked in the main exposition.

The former note is therefore scrapped as a publication artefact. Its mathematics has not been declared false; the problem is the one-sided paper boundary and the resulting duplication.

The only two coherent successors

1. Keep one main mathematical paper and fold only the necessary specialist exposition into it; or
2. revive a matched pair of specialist notes, one for Problem 249 and one for Problem 257, with equally clear jobs and boundaries.

There is no active plan to polish the former 249-only note in isolation.

What was preserved

The full source and rendered PDF that preceded this notice remain in `paper/archive/` under filenames ending `-retired-2026-07-17`. They are retained as provenance and a source of potentially reusable exposition, not as current publications.

The main Erdős mathematics paper remains a separate live manuscript. This retirement notice makes no mathematical status change and must not be used to infer that either open problem has been solved.

Retired 17 July 2026.